

Texas WIC Health and Human Services Commission

Effective July 1, 2026

Policy No. BF:02.0

Local Agency Breastfeeding Coordinator

Purpose

To ensure that qualified, designated staff administer (plan, implement and evaluate) breastfeeding (BF) education and support activities. To ensure that breastfeeding education and support is planned, scheduled and provided to address the needs of breastfeeding participants.

Authority

7 CRF Part 246.11

Policy

Each Local Agency (LA) must designate a BF Coordinator who ensures that breastfeeding lessons, materials, and other information presented to WIC participants contain accurate, current, culturally appropriate, and evidence-based information, per United States Department of Agriculture (USDA) policy.

Procedures

- I. Each LA must designate a BF Coordinator to oversee breastfeeding promotion and support activities.
- II. The LA BF Coordinator must:
 - A. Be an International Board Certified Lactation Consultant (IBCLC) or have received specialized breastfeeding training in accordance with [Policy TR:03.0](#), or must successfully complete the certification or training within one year of being designated in the role.
 - B. Be qualified as a Certifying Authority unless an exception was granted by the State Agency (SA) prior to June 1, 2021.
 - C. Have experience in program management.
 - D. Have, at minimum, one year of experience in counseling breastfeeding women.

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- E. Be trained according to [Policy TR:03.0](#). Documentation of the BF coordinator's initial and on-going training must be maintained at the LA for review.
 - F. Complete the State Peer Counselor (PC) Management training within one year of employment.
 - G. Attend the annual WIC Program's Nutrition and Breastfeeding conference every fiscal year. Other conferences or trainings may be used as a substitute.
- III. In the event the BF Coordinator is on extended leave, the LA must ensure an interim lactation expert, such as an LA PC Coordinator or Designated Breastfeeding Expert, provides oversight and management of the PC program, including assistance with complex problems outside of the PC's scope of practice and referral expertise.
- IV. The BF Coordinator must oversee/coordinate all aspects of breastfeeding training, education and documentation at the LA. They may work in conjunction with the Training Coordinator, Nutrition Education Coordinator and clinic supervisory staff. The BF Coordinator is responsible for overseeing:
 - A. The BF portion of the annual NE/BF Plan (see [Policy NE:02.0](#));
 - B. BF activities including but not limited to:
 - 1. Ensuring the clinic environment promotes and supports BF according to [Policy BF:01.0](#);
 - 2. Providing the opportunity for all pregnant and BF WIC participants to meet with a PC,
 - 3. Ensuring participants receive individual counseling and nutrition education classes that promote and support BF;
 - 4. Ensuring all individual counseling and nutrition education classes that address infant feeding support the mother's breastfeeding goals; and

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- 5. Ensuring BF promotion/support activities are evaluated, and necessary changes are implemented to ensure that mothers reach their BF goals.
- C. Managing the LA PC Program if there is not an LA PC Coordinator
- D. Promoting and supporting breastfeeding in the community by networking with and providing outreach to other health professionals, community organizations and stakeholders to inform them of WIC breastfeeding resources.
- E. Keeping the Breastfeeding Referral Protocol and Client Breastfeeding Resource List up to date (See [Policy BF:01.0](#)).
- F. Monitoring LA breastfeeding rates.
- G. Evaluating BF education and support. Quality management activities related to BF must be conducted annually (at minimum) by the LA and:
 - 1. Must include evaluating breastfeeding educational activities for accuracy and positive presentation of breastfeeding.
 - 2. Must include observation of group and individual breastfeeding education and support sessions to ensure accurate and appropriate delivery of information in a client-centered way.
 - 3. Results should be used to determine and plan staff training.
 - 4. Participant feedback related to breastfeeding to include but not limited to the Texas WIC Feeding Practices Survey, should be used to plan future breastfeeding education and support activities.